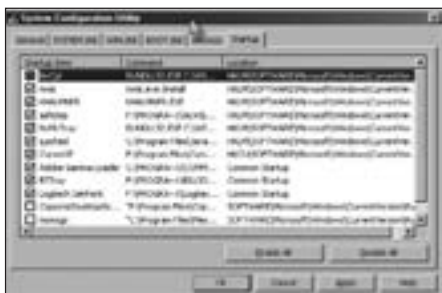


the services that are launched at bootup. Each service has a checkbox, by un-checking which, you can stop that particular service from being launched at startup. You should get a feel of which services are required and which are not by looking at the filename and target directory. For example, you might see “winampa” listed, and you can guess that this is the Winamp agent. You probably don’t need it to run. Similarly, “realsched” is the RealNetworks scheduler, which you probably don’t need. Un-check the ones that you feel are not required, and select ‘Apply’.

The ‘Start\Programs\Start’ directory in Windows XP is the place the OS uses to launch application shortcuts at bootup. Clearing this folder will cause the programs to not launch at bootup. This folder also happens to be the target of most spyware and adware. Windows XP does not put any system-critical files in this folder, so even if you’re not sure of the application a particular shortcut refers to, just delete it.



The Startup tab in MSConfig

6. Remove unwanted fonts

During bootup, Windows XP scans the ‘Fonts’ directory and loads them for the system to use. Windows XP by default installs fonts required for its operation as well as those for use in other applications such as Word, Notepad, IE, etc. Of these default fonts, most people hardly use more than 10. The remaining fonts simply sit there and occupy system resources, slowing down the bootup process as well. A simple way to address this situation is to move unused fonts to a separate directory.

Create a new folder, say ‘C:\Fonts_backup’. Go to Start > Control panel > Fonts. In the ‘Fonts’ folder that opens, select all